Mahla Shourian

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Education

2027 (Expected)	**Ph.D. in Economics**, University of Oklahoma, Norman, OK Dissertation: *The Economics of the Family: Essays on Wages, Fertility, and Divorce* Committee: Pallab Ghosh (Chair), Firat Demir, Tyler Ransom, Joan Hamory, Nghiem Q. Huynh
2017	M.A. in Development Economics, Allameh Tabataba'i University, Tehran, Iran Thesis: *Gender Wage Gap, Glass Ceiling, and Sticky Floor in Iran's Labor Market*
2014	B.A. in Commercial Economics, Allameh Tabataba'i University, Tehran, Iran

Research Fields

Primary	Labor Economics; Economics of Gender and the Family
Secondary	Public Economics; Health Economics; Demographic Economics

Job Market Paper

When the Marriage Market Fails: How Changes in Relative Wages Shape Childbearing Decisions.
Using IPUMS Census and ACS microdata and a Bartik-style shift–share instrument for potential wages, I estimate how a rising female-to-male wage ratio affects U.S. fertility. A 10% increase in the ratio lowers the share of women with a child by 4 percentage points, reduces completed fertility by 0.7 children, and delays first birth by three years, through marriage, specialization breakdown, and bargaining channels.

Publications

- "Power of Public Health Advice: Effectiveness and Spillover Effects of Federal Vaccine Recommendations" (with Junying Zhao, Ahmed El Fatmaoui, Pallab Ghosh, and Bethanie Lor). *Public Health in Practice*, 2025. doi.org/10.1016/j.puhip.2025.100667

Working Papers

- "When the Marriage Market Fails: How Changes in Relative Wages Shape Childbearing Decisions" (Job Market Paper).
- "The Relative Wage and Marriage after 2010: A Comment on Shenhav (2021)" (with Pallab Ghosh).
- "Children Who Witness: Early-Life Exposure to Unilateral Divorce Laws and Intimate Partner Violence in Adulthood" (with Pallab Ghosh).
- "A Slow Burn: The Opioid Epidemic and the Rise in Teen Fertility" (with Pallab Ghosh).

Works in Progress

- "Educated and Alone? How Gender Imbalances in Higher Education Shape the Marriage Market."
- "From Mother to Daughter: Policy Influences on Teenage Pregnancy."

Conference Presentations

2026	ASSA Annual Meeting (Philadelphia, PA); WEAI 101st Conference (Denver, CO)
2025	SEA 95th Annual Meeting (Tampa, FL); WEAI 100th Conference (San Francisco, CA)
2024	SEA 94th Annual Meeting (Washington, D.C.); WEAI 99th Annual Conference (Seattle, WA); MEA 88th Annual Meeting (Chicago, IL); MVEA Annual Conference (Kansas City, MO)

Fellowships and Awards

- CSWEP Mentoring Workshop Travel Grant (2025)
- DFCAS Dissertation Completion Fellowship, University of Oklahoma (2025)
- Chong Liew Summer Research Award, University of Oklahoma (2024, 2025)
- Robberson Research and Travel Grant, University of Oklahoma (2023, 2024, 2025)
- GSS Research and Conference Grants, University of Oklahoma (2023, 2024, 2025)

Restricted Data and Research Experience

2024–Present	Approved BLS access to restricted-use NLSY79 and NLSY79-CYA data via a secure enclave; disclosure-review and confidentiality training completed.
2022–2023	Research Assistant (Economics and Public Health), University of Oklahoma
2014–2017	Research Assistant, Allameh Tabataba'i University

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record, in person, University of Oklahoma

- Elements of Statistics (ECON 2843): Fall 2026
- Principles of Economics–Micro (ECON 1123): Spring 2027

Instructor of Record, online, University of Oklahoma

- Elements of Statistics (ECON 2843): Summer 2023, Fall 2023, Summer 2024, Fall 2024, Summer 2025
- Principles of Economics–Micro (ECON 1123): Summer 2023

Teaching Assistant and Guest Lecturer, University of Oklahoma

- Intermediate Microeconomic Theory (ECON 3113)
- Introduction to Applied Econometrics (ECON 4233)
- Labor Economics I (ECON 6433, Ph.D.)
- Econometrics II (ECON 5243, Ph.D.)
- Labor Problems (ECON 3513)
- Economics of Discrimination (ECON 4513)

Professional Service

2025	Referee, *The Economic and Labour Relations Review*
2025	Member, Economics Faculty Search Committee, University of Oklahoma

SKILLS

Software	Stata, R, Julia, MATLAB, LaTeX, Git
Languages	English (fluent); Persian (native)

REFERENCES

Pallab Ghosh (Chair)
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